- Compared to figure 7.5 the releases in this chart were smaller, between 15 and 25 tasks instead of the 60 in figure 7.5. Along with the smaller releases came less support and more consistency.
- Average development time of tasks went up a lot, from one to four days.

If the team is looking for consistency in their release cycle, certainly the pattern in figure 7.6 is the pattern they want to replicate. If that's the case, then a longer development time isn't a bad thing and perhaps the team should consider extremely low average development times a red flag.

7.3. How to create metrics

> *"A model is a formal representation of a theory."*
>
> *Kenneth A. Bollen*

The end goal is to get our team members to perform as well as they can. To get there we want to be able to track what matters most in the context of our team and combine that data into a form that's easy to track and communicate. In chapter 1 I talked about how to find what matters most for your team by asking questions and mind mapping. Now that we've gone through all the data that you can use, we're going to start putting it together to answer questions that lead to better team performance.

Before we start creating metrics, we should lay ground rules for what makes a good metric. The following guidelines are a good place to start:

- Metrics should create actionable insight:
    - Do track metrics that you can respond to should they identify a problem.
    - Don't track metrics you can't do anything about or haven't taken the time to understand the meaning of.
- Metrics should align with core business and team tenets: